

General Knowledge

Art & Culture

STUDY NOTES

Indian Music



INDIAN MUSIC

Two Types of Classical Music can be found in India, which are: Hindustani Music and Carnatic Music.

Hindustani Music

- Hindustani classical music is the classical music of northern regions of the Indian subcontinent.
- It may also be called North Indian classical music or, in Hindustani, Shastriya sangeet.
- Hindustani Music Compositions are as follows:

Dhrupad: The term Dhrupad denotes both the verse form of the poetry and the style in which it is sung.

Dhamar: Dhamar is one of the talas used in Hindustani classical music.

Ghazal: The ghazal is composed of a minimum of five couplets that are structurally, thematically, and emotionally autonomous.

Tappa: Tappa is an Indian semi-classical vocal music, with its specialty of rapid, delicate and complex arrangement. 'Tappa' means leaping, springing up and hopping.

Tarana: Tarana is a vocal form of Hindustani Music. It is said that it was developed by Music legend Amir Khusrau.

Khayal is a major form of Hindustani classical music and is known for its romantic poetry, extensive ornamentation of ragas, and technical virtuosity.

Gharanas in Hindustani Music

Gharana	Founder	Characteristics/Style	Prominent Exponents/Famous Musicians
Gwalior Gharana	Nathan Peerbaksh	Emphasizes purity of ragas, clarity of notes, systematic teaching, preservation of ancient compositions	Ustad Haddu Khan, Ustad Nathu Khan, Krishnarao Shankar Pandit, Raja Bhaiyya Poonchwale
Patiala Gharana	Mian Kallu	Focus on intricate ornamentation, fast-paced taans, blending of Hindustani and Carnatic music elements	Bade Ghulam Ali Khan, Ustad Bade Fateh Ali Khan
Kirana Gharana	Abdul Kareem Khan, Abdul Wahid Khan	Emphasizes development of a single note (gayaki ang), meditative and introspective style	Ustad Abdul Karim Khan, Pandit Bhimsen Joshi, Prabha Atre, Heerabai Badokar
Mewati Gharana	Ustad Ghagge Nazir Khan	Celebrated for emotive renditions of Hindustani classical music	Pandit Jasraj, Tarana Singer, Pandit Rattan Mohan Sharma
Jaipur Gharana	Ustad Alladiya Khan	It is known for its energetic and forceful style, rhythmic wizardry, and technical aspects	Vidyagauri Adkar, Malikaarjun Mansur, Kishori Amonkar, Ashwini Bhide Deshpande
Sahaswan Gharana	Ustad Inayat Hussain Khan	It is known for its intricate and elaborate renditions.	Gulam Mustafa Khan, Ustad Rashid Khan

Agra Gharana	Hajisujan Khan	Known for purity of ragas, intricate ornamentation, blend of dhrupad and Khayal styles	Ustad Faiyaz Khan, Ustad Vilayat Hussain Khan "Pranpiya", Dinkar Kakini, Malka Jaan
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Carnatic Music

- It is a system of music associated with the present-day states of Southern India namely: Karnataka, Andhra Pradesh, Telangana, Tamil Nadu and Kerala.
- Important Elements of Carnatic Music are Sruti, Swara, Raga System and Tala Systems.
- Two important or significant forms of Carnatic Music are Varnam and Kriti.

Varnam: Varnam is a composition which exists only in Carnatic music and nowhere else in the world of music. Varnam is a grammatical guideline of Raga, a touchstone for the grammar of raga.

Kriti: Kritis refers to the composition whose significance lies mainly in its music and not in its sahitya. Kriti consists of pallavi, anupallavi and charana.

Gharanas in Carnatic Music

Gharana/Quartet	Contributions/Characteristics	Prominent Musicians/Artists
Tanjore Quartet	Pioneered popularisation of Bharatanatyam dance; composed of numerous varnams, kritis, and tillandsias	Chinnayya, Ponnayya, Sivanandam, Vadivelu

Mysore Gharana	Known for intricate rhythmic patterns and tala structures	Veena Seshanna, Veena Doraiswamy Iyengar
Palakkad Gharana	The rich repertoire in both vocal and instrumental music	Palakkad Mani Iyer, Palghat Raghu

Folk Music

- It is the music that originates in traditional popular culture or that is written in such a style.
- Folk music is typically of unknown authorship and is transmitted orally from generation to generation.
- India has a diverse Folk Music culture due to its enormous cultural diversity.
- The existence of linguistic diversity has resulted in Folk Music being sung in all of those languages and their regional dialects.

Indian States and Folk Music

Region	Folk Song	Description
Uttar Pradesh	Rasiya Geet	Sung during daily chores; uses Kettle Drums, Dholak, Harmonium, and Cymbals.
	Hori	Sung during Holi, based on Radha Krishna stories.
	Sohar	Sung at the birth of a baby boy.
	Kajri	Sung by women during the rainy season; uses Sitar, Sarod, Veena, etc.
	Qawwali	Sufi devotional songs; use Bulbul Tarang, Harmonium, Sarangi, and Tabla.
Jammu and Kashmir	Bhakha	Sung post-harvest; accompanied by Harmonium.
	Chhakri	Group song in Kashmir; uses Harmonium, Sarangi, and Rubab.
	Ladishah	Narrates socio-political issues; uses Dhukar.
Maharashtra	Lavani	Dance and music were performed to entertain soldiers using

		Dholki.
	Owi	Sung by women during work; describes women's lives.
	Powada	Heroic ballad of past heroes like Shivaji.
Uttarakhand	Jhoda	Group song with men and women singing and dancing.
	Thadya	Important form of music, initially in royal courts.
Arunachal Pradesh	Ja-Jin-Ja	Group songs performed by men and women.
	Baryi	Sung on special occasions; narrates history and mythology.
Goa	Ovi	Sung by women during work; focuses on marriages, pregnancy, and lullabies.
	Mando	The blend of Indian and Western music; uses Guitar, Violin, and Ghumat drum.
	Banvarh	Funeral song; uses Dhol and Shehnai.
Punjab	Tappa	Semi-classical; depicts lover's plight, uses Tabla, Dholak.
	Bhangra	Folk music with dance; uses Dhol, Tumbi, Harmonium, etc.
	Jugni	Sung at weddings; uses Wind instruments, Dholak, and Cymbals.
West Bengal	Baul	Sung by Bauls; influenced by tantric knowledge; uses Ektara, Khamak, and Dotara.
	Bhatiali	Sung by fishing communities.
	Rabindra Sangeet	Folk songs by Rabindranath Tagore on varied topics.
Madhya Pradesh	Alha	Heroic ballad linked to Mahabharata; sung in Braj, Awadhi, and Bhojpuri languages.
Assam	Bihu	Sung during Bihu festival; uses Dhol, Pipe, Gogona, etc.
Tamil Nadu	Villu Pattu	Bow song with a social message and mythology.
	Nattupura Padalgal	Sung during harvest season.
	Kummi Pattu	Sung during rituals and festivals.

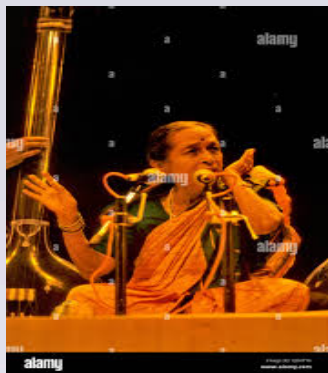
	Ammanaivari	Praises Chola monarchs; sung by women during games.
Karnataka	Bhavageethe	Focuses on emotional expression; associated with nature, love.
	Jaanapada Geethe	Narrates everyday life; uses wind and percussion instruments.
Gujarat	Dandiya	Sung during Dandiya Raas; uses Dhol, Dholak, Tabla.
	Garba	Sung during Garba dance; uses Dhol, Harmonium, and Drums.
Rajasthan	Pani Hari	Sung by women fetching water; discusses daily life and relationships.
	Maand	Glorifies Rajput rulers; uses Sarangi and percussion instruments.
	Pankhida	Sung by peasants; uses Algoza and Manjira.
	Teej	Sung during Teej festival.
	Lotia	Sung during Lotia festival.
Chhattisgarh	Pandavani	Based on Mahabharata, Bhima as the hero; uses Tambura, Manjira, Dholak, and Tabla.
Kerala	Bhuta	Music accompanies rituals to ward off evil spirits.
Manipur	Sana Lamok	Sung during the coronation ceremony.
	Khongjom Parva	Ballad genre narrating the battle of Khongjom.
Mizoram	Saikuti Zai	Sung in praise of warriors and hunters.
	Chai Hia	Sung during the Chai dance.
Sikkim	Gha To Kito	Describes the natural beauty of the state.
	Lu Khangthamo	Thanksgiving song performed by old and young.
Bihar	Sukar ke Biah	Sung in Bhojpuri style narrates Sukar's Biah.
Jharkhand	Domkach	Popular music accompanied by dance.
Garhwal Region	Ghasiyari Geet	Sung by women collecting grass for cattle.
	Basant Geet	Sung during the Basant festival.

Himachal Pradesh	Laman	Conversational song between boys and girls in Kullu Valley.
Odisha	Daskathia	Ballad song using the instrument 'Kathi' (Ram Tali).
Andhra Pradesh	Burra Katha	Dramatic ballad; uses Tambura while narrating the drama.

Some Famous Singers of India:

Singers	Description
Amir Khusrau 	He was an Indian singer, poet and scholar who lived under the Delhi Sultanate. He was an iconic figure in the cultural history of the Indian subcontinent. He was a mystic and a spiritual disciple of Nizamuddin Auliya of Delhi.
Begum Akhtar 	Begum Akhtar, also known as the Mallika-e-Ghazal (The Queen Ghazals), it was a series of personal tragedies that formed the basis of her legendary vocal performances. Her magic lay in not merely expressing this pain, love and hope, but translating these emotions in ways that future generations would empathise with and understand.
Pandit Bhimsen Gururaj Joshi	He was an Indian vocalist basically from Karnataka, belonging to the Hindustani classical tradition. He is known for the khayal form of singing, as well as for his popular renditions of devotional music. Bhimsen Joshi belongs to the Kirana gharana tradition of Hindustani Classical Music.

	
D K Pattammal 	She was an Indian Carnatic musician and playback singer in the Tamil movie industry. She along with her contemporaries M. S. Subbulakshmi and M. L. Vasanthakumari are referred to as Carnatic Music's Female Trinity.
G N Balasubramaniam 	Popularly known as GNB, he was a singer of Carnatic music. Semmangudi Srinivasa Iyer and Madurai Mani Iyer and GNB are referred to as the male trinity of Carnatic Music of the 20th century.
Gangubai Hanagal	She was an Indian singer of the khyal genre of Hindustani classical music from Karnataka, who was known for her deep and powerful voice. Hangal belonged to the Kirana gharana.



Gundecha Brothers



The Gundecha Brothers are Indian classical singers of the dhrupad genre of the Dagar vani. From 1985 to 2019 the duo consisted of brothers Umakant Gundecha and Ramakant Gundecha and were awarded the Padma Shri for art for 2012.

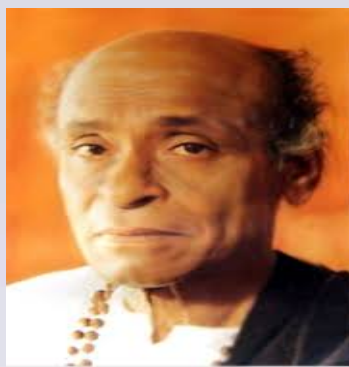
M S Subbulakshmi



Madurai Shanmukhavadiyu Subbulakshmi was an Indian Carnatic singer from Madurai, Tamil Nadu. She was the first musician ever to be awarded the Bharat Ratna, India's highest civilian honour.

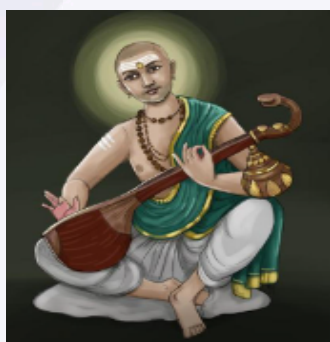
Mallikarjun Manasur

Mallikarjun Mansur was an Indian classical singer from Karnataka, and an excellent vocalist in the Khyal style in the Jaipur-Atrauli Gharana.



Pt. Mallikarjun Mansur

Mutthuswamy Dikshitar



Muthuswamy Dikshitar, the youngest of the Musical Trinity comprising Saint Thyagaraja, Shyama Shastri and himself. Dikshitar is said to have composed almost 450 to 500 compositions, most of which are performed to this day at music concerts. Dikshitar travelled to many holy shrines throughout his life and composed krithis on the deities and temples he visited.

Pandit Jasraj



Pandit Jasraj was an Indian classical vocalist, belonging to the Mewati gharana. His musical career was spread over 75 years resulting in national and international fame, numerous major awards and accolades.